

AI Tools for Work and Study: workshop roadmap

DGP0959 · Workshop roadmap · Graham Pellegrini

Eight practical two-hour workshops, Wednesdays 12:00–14:00, starting 14 October. The venue is ELT; check your current timetable for changes. The unit's assessment is attendance. Practice outputs below are learning activities, not an added examination or graded project.

The introduction includes one course-map slide: October covers tools, prompts and documents; November covers communication, planning, presentations and data; December brings the skills together in a personal workflow.

The course follows the commissioned study-unit sequence. We create our own case studies, fictional inputs, exercises and templates. Every session follows: explain the task → work through an example together → try a variation → check and revise → save a useful template.

1 · Your AI Toolkit · 14 October

Chapters: class starting point and access; a simple AI mental model; tool categories; matching tools to tasks; first prompt; checking and human decisions.

Work together: Turn three fictional class-preparation notes into a checklist. Check that no task was lost or invented, then ask for shorter wording. No document upload or scheduling is needed.

Try it: Begin with three familiar tasks: organise notes, draft a message, or find information. Choose a tool category and test one simple prompt. Three additional scenarios are optional.

Keep: Toolkit map, setup guide and task-choice checklist.

Visuals: Tool map, four-step workflow, annotated prompt/result. Introduce optional AI for All learning and university-account access.

2 · Getting Better Results · 21 October

Chapters: purpose; context; audience; constraints; output format; examples; revisions and alternatives.

Work together: Compare “Make me a study plan” with a request that supplies available hours and deadlines. Change one instruction at a time and discuss the effect.

Try it: Improve a prompt in three passes and record what changed. Ask for missing information instead of accepting invented details.

Keep: Prompt canvas and revision checklist.

Visuals: Colour-annotated prompt anatomy and before/after comparison. Introduce advanced techniques only after the basic structure is comfortable.

3 · Research and Documents · 28 October

Chapters: orientation versus evidence; supplied sources; summary; document comparison; actions; verification and acknowledgement.

Work together: Compare two fictional assignment briefs, including a changed deadline. Mark the exact passage supporting each extracted claim.

Try it: Produce a short briefing with known facts, unknowns and checks. Open original sources for any external claims.

Keep: Document prompt set and claim/source table.

Visuals: Annotated excerpts and a claim-to-source diagram. Avoid treating a generated citation as proof that a source exists.

4 · Writing and Professional Communication · 4 November

Chapters: audience and intent; drafting from notes; tone; clarity; preserving facts and voice; final review.

Work together: Draft a fictional clarification email from messy notes. Check whether it invented a reason or commitment; revise for a different audience.

Try it: Write two communications from the same facts, then mark your human edits.

Keep: Email/brief prompts and final-review checklist.

Visuals: Annotated message and audience comparison. Coursework use follows the relevant assignment instructions.

5 · Planning, Meetings and Project Support · 11 November

Chapters: goals; task breakdown; owners and deadlines; dependencies; agendas; minutes; progress updates.

Work together: Turn fictional student-event notes into an action list. Separate confirmed decisions from suggestions and flag missing owners.

Try it: Create a mini plan, agenda and progress update; check consistency across them.

Keep: Planning and meeting templates.

Visuals: Timeline, simple dependency diagram and action table. Use supplied fictional meeting notes rather than recording classmates.

6 · Presentations and Visual Content · 18 November

Chapters: audience; storyline; one message per slide; evidence; diagrams/images; speaker notes; critique.

Work together: Turn a cluttered slide into a focused slide with an explanatory visual. Compare an illustrative image with a diagram supporting a factual claim.

Try it: Outline a five-slide talk in your field, including a visual purpose and speaking notes for each slide.

Keep: Storyboard and visual-prompt template.

Visuals: Before/after slide, editable diagram, clearly labelled illustration. Paid image generation is optional; drawing a visual concept achieves the same planning goal.

7 · Tables and Data Without Coding · 25 November

Chapters: fields and units; missing data; questions; totals; patterns; charts; supported conclusions.

Work together: Inspect a small fictional event-attendance CSV with a duplicate and a missing value. Agree how to handle these before asking for a summary; check a total manually.

Try it: Produce a short insight with evidence, a limitation and a next step. Challenge an unsupported causal claim.

Keep: Data-question prompts and reporting template.

Visuals: Source table, highlighted evidence cells and one labelled chart. Complex dashboards and automation are extensions if the class is ready.

8 · Build Your Professional AI Workflow · 2 December

Chapters: choose a real task; inputs; reusable prompts; tool handoffs; checks; human decisions; reflection.

Work together: Connect a fictional event brief, plan, message and slide outline. Notice how an unchecked error can travel between outputs.

Try it: Design a workflow for your own field; exchange feedback on one checking step. Use safe or fictional inputs.

Keep: Personal workflow, prompt library and quality checklist.

Visuals: Workflow with inputs, outputs and human checkpoints. Sharing is formative practice; this is not a newly imposed graded final assignment.

Preparing and participating

Use the [setup guide](#) and [starting-point check](#). Account setup happens outside the main exercise where possible. We will provide paired and saved-output options.

Follow your own tutor's instructions for assessed work. Keep prompts, source notes and drafts so you can explain your use of AI. Our workshop practice does not override another unit's rules.

The [official DegreePlus timetable](#) is the public administrative reference. The workshops above are our proposed teaching content; chapter detail can adapt to class experience.